Michelle L. Parson

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EDUCATION

Michigan State University, **College of Communication Arts and Sciences,** East Lansing, MI May 2027
Bachelor of Arts in Information Science, Focus in Human-Centered Technologies | Minor in Philosophy and Law

- Sparty Foundation Scholarship Recipient (for leadership and academic success)
- Undergraduate Research Award Funding Recipient (2025, 2026)

UX RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

WeSpeak – Client Project, Imagine Software, East Lansing, MI Sept. 2026 - Present
UX Research and Design Intern, Design Team

- Translated a language-learning board game into a digital user interface, creating high-fidelity prototypes in Figma
- Conducted user research with learners and language experts to surface key insights guiding design decisions
- Partnered with the software development team to integrate research findings into user-centered design solutions
- Ran usability testing sessions, presented synthesized findings, and applied design improvements based on results

Michigan State University College of Communication Arts and Sciences, East Lansing, MI Feb. 2026 - Present
Student Research Assistant

- **Research Highlight:** Designed and led a mixed-methods study on mobility-limited residents' digital access, translated findings into ThirdSpace, a Best Prototype-winning digital user interface (wireframes created in Figma)
- Designed interview and survey instruments, performed qualitative and quantitative analysis on behavior patterns
- Translated multifaceted research findings into clear, actionable insights, presented at the 2026 University Undergraduate Research and Arts Forum, used peer feedback for iteration to write 2 research papers in progress

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Spartans For Duggan, Duggan Gubernatorial Campaign 2026, East Lansing, MI May 2025 - Sept. 2025
Senior Intern, Audience Research

- Conducted audience research to improve voter outreach messaging across channels, produced 4–6 essays weekly
- Collaborated with campaign leadership on recruitment and engagement; adapted messaging for diverse audiences

Michigan State University Recreational Sports and Fitness Services, East Lansing, MI Aug. 2024 - Dec. 2025
Group Fitness Instructor

- Designed engaging experiences for participants of varying skill levels; doubled participation via targeted outreach
- Adjusted structure based on participant feedback and engagement patterns, tailored 17 weeks' worth of content

Leisure Unlimited, West Bloomfield, MI Dec. 2022 - Present
Assistant Coach

- Delivered specialized instruction to 500+ participants, ages 3–14, with diverse communication and learning needs
- Built strong relationships with participants and caregivers through clear, consistent feedback and adaptations

SKILLS & TOOLS

Research: Mixed-Methods Research, Qualitative Analysis, Quantitative Analysis, Usability Testing, HCI, Contextual Inquiry, User Interviews, Survey Design, Journey Mapping, Data Analysis; **Design:** User Interface Design, Interactive Prototyping, User-Centered Design, Accessibility, User Experience Design, Web Design; **Tools:** Figma, Qualtrics, Python, HTML, GitHub, Adobe, Canva, Microsoft Office, Google Suite; **Additional:** Leadership, Policy Analysis, AI Governance

AFFILIATIONS & AWARDS

MSU UX Association | Imagine Software | Info Science Club | Social Cognition & Media Psychology | Philosophy Club
Awards: MSU Designathon 2026 Award for Best Prototype, ThirdSpace
Projects: Best Dressed – create-your-own-adventure interactive fashion game, logic tree created with Python
Other Interests: MSU Student Food Bank Volunteer, Mediation, Group Exercise, Reading, Painting, Collaging, Running